

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Hurricane delivers Jamaica epic blow

Melissa ranks as one of strongest Atlantic storms on record

By John Myers Jr. and Dánica Coto
Associated Press

KINGSTON, Jamaica — Heavy floodwaters swept across southwestern Jamaica, winds tore roofs off buildings and boulders tumbled into roads Tuesday as Hurricane Melissa came ashore as a catastrophic Category 5 storm, one of the strongest Atlantic hurricanes on record.

Desmond McKenzie, deputy chairman of Jamaica's Disaster Risk Management Council, urged people to seek shelter and stay indoors as the storm crosses the island.

"Jamaica, this is not the time to be brave," he said.

The Jamaican government said it had done all it could to prepare as it warned of devastating damage from the strongest hurricane to hit the island since recordkeeping began 174 years ago.

"There is no infrastructure in the region that can withstand a Category 5," Prime Minister Andrew Holness said. "The question now is the speed of recovery. That's the challenge."

Landslides, fallen trees and numerous power outages were reported as Melissa came ashore near New Hope, with officials cautioning that the cleanup and damage assessment could be slow. The storm is expected to slice diagonally across the island and head for Cuba, where the first intermittent rains were falling.

Colin Bogle, a Mercy Corps adviser based near Kingston, said most families are sheltering in place despite the government ordering evacuations in flood-prone communities. He was sheltering with his grandmother in Portmore, where everything went dark earlier in the morning after a loud explosion.

"The noise is relentless," he said. "People are anxious and

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Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino leaves the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse after testifying Tuesday. BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

'Not how any of us want to live'

Judge orders Border Patrol boss Bovino to court daily to report use of force

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A visibly displeased federal judge on Tuesday ordered Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino to start coming to court every day to detail any confrontations his immigration enforcement officers have had with the public, a move that comes as allegations have mounted that agents are indiscriminately throwing tear gas in Chicago neighborhoods and using inappropriate force

against residents and reporters.

During a remarkable hour-long session with Bovino on the witness stand Tuesday, U.S. District Judge Sara Ellis instructed the 30-year border patrol veteran to get his own body-worn camera and send her every use-of-force report — and accompanying bodycam footage — filed since "Operation Midway Blitz" began nearly two months ago.

The judge spoke at one point in somber tones about a fracas

■ Hundreds of students marched in Little Village, denouncing recent ICE action. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

■ People protested outside Palatine police headquarters, after one of the department's officers aided federal enforcement. **Page 6**

in the Old Irving Park neighborhood over the weekend where agents tackled angry residents and deployed tear gas on a quiet street as children were preparing

to march in a Halloween parade to a nearby grammar school.

"These kids, you can imagine, their sense of safety was shattered on Saturday, and it's going to take a long time for that to come back — if ever," Ellis told Bovino, who was sitting on the witness stand in his military-green Border Protection uniform and duty belt. "That's not how any of us want to live. I know you wouldn't want to live that way."

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A group of people wear transportation-themed T-shirts and cardboard cutouts while waiting to deliver petitions to legislators during the legislative session at the Illinois Capitol, Tuesday in Springfield. JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

House Democrats weigh transit funding plan, eye billionaire and streaming taxes

By Jeremy Gornier, Olivia Olander and Talia Soglin
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Illinois House Democrats began pushing Tuesday for their own plan to provide an overhaul of the Chicago region's mass transit systems, holding firm against plans to install a new fee on food deliveries and a real estate transfer tax and floating a menu of poten-

tial options to raise \$1.5 billion in new revenue.

With time running short in the General Assembly's fall veto session yet needing to pass some legislation to stave off job cuts and service reductions, key House Democratic negotiators said they were weighing several alternatives to the fees and taxes included in a bill that cleared the Senate in the eleventh hour this spring but failed to pass the House.

Among the ideas the Democratic-led House was considering included a sales tax, a tax on streaming services and a tax on unrealized gains on billionaires' assets — known in shorthand as a billionaire's tax, key lawmakers said. The goal was to assemble enough new funding to secure the \$1.5 billion advocates say is needed to adequately fund the

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Chicago, Cook County and state appeal Trump's denial of disaster declaration

Request would unlock federal aid after severe summer flooding

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

The city of Chicago, Cook County and the state of Illinois are appealing President Donald Trump's denial last week of a disaster declaration that would have unlocked federal financial assistance for survivors and public repairs after heavy rains and flooding in the state in July and August.

A joint news release on Tuesday noted that flooding from the storms on July 25-28 and Aug. 16-19 caused "widespread property damage, prolonged power outages, and significant disruptions to transportation and essential services" across Illinois. The heavy rains displaced residents, left thousands without electricity, led to collapsed ceilings from water damage,

flooded basements and roadways, overflowed rivers, broken boilers, furnaces and other large appliances, and triggered ground stops at Midway and O'Hare International airports.

"I will say, Illinois is not alone. They've rejected requests from a number of states this year already," said Andy Winkler, managing director of housing and infrastructure policy at the Washington-based Bipartisan Policy Center and manager of the think tank's Disaster Response Reform Task Force. "This batch of rejections — it looks more political, but it is consistent with what they've been doing across the board, to really only approve the highest-profile disasters."

In recent years, as climate change has fueled more intense events from flooding to wildfires, the federal government has taken on a larger financial responsibility for natural

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Not your average Michael Jackson fan



Every weekend, Enrico "Rico" Hampton dons makeup, boots and gloves and goes wherever he's called. He's performed for everyone from Louis Farrakhan to the Chicago Bulls over the years. **Arts & Living**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 54 Low 43

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 302 © Chicago Tribune

